

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 3

APUSH-SAQ3-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Period 3: 1754–1800

Period: Period 3: 1754–1800

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of the American Revolution argues that Patriot resistance grew mainly from constitutional conflict within the British Empire. According to this interpretation, colonial leaders challenged Parliament’s authority because they believed taxation, representation, and imperial administration threatened the rights of English subjects.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of revolutionary society argues that the Revolution cannot be understood only as an elite constitutional dispute. According to this interpretation, ordinary artisans, farmers, women, enslaved people, and local committees helped turn imperial protest into a broader political movement that changed expectations about participation and rights.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of the American Revolution.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing constitutional and imperial disputes among colonial leaders, while Source B emphasizes popular mobilization and broader social participation.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as colonial opposition to the Stamp Act, “virtual representation,” the Declaratory Act, taxation without representation, colonial assemblies’ claims to authority, or debates over Parliament’s power.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as nonimportation movements, Sons of Liberty activity, women’s boycotts and homespun production, committees of correspondence, crowd actions, petitions by enslaved people, or local militia mobilization.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should avoid reducing the Revolution to only taxes or only democratic ideals. It should show how constitutional arguments by colonial elites interacted with broader forms of popular political action and social mobilization.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ3-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Mexican American high school student writing to a local school board after student walkouts, Los Angeles, 1968.

“Our parents came here to work and build a future, but in school we are told that our language is a problem and our history is invisible. We do not ask for special treatment. We ask for teachers who expect us to graduate, counselors who do not send us away from college, and classes that show Mexican Americans as part of this country’s story. If the district calls this disorder, it has not listened to the order we have lived under.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader civil rights activism in the United States during the 1960s and 1970s.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Chicano Movement, East Los Angeles school walkouts, educational inequality, Mexican American civil rights activism, bilingual education debates, or broader rights movements of the 1960s.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s perspective as a Mexican American student influenced the argument by emphasizing school discrimination, language, curriculum, low expectations, college access, and recognition of Mexican American identity.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader connection, such as youth activism, ethnic pride movements, challenges to institutional discrimination, demands for educational reform, Latino/a civil rights organizing, Black Power influence, women’s rights, Native activism, or Asian American activism.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the source to civil rights activism beyond the Black freedom struggle without ignoring common themes such as equal access, institutional discrimination, and community organizing. Strong responses will explain why education became a key site of protest.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ3-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Period 6: 1865–1898

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described data table created for this practice exam.

The table is titled “Selected Trends in Southern Agriculture, 1870–1900.”

Indicator | 1870 | 1885 | 1900

Share of Southern farms operated by tenants or sharecroppers | about 25% | about 45% | more than 50%

Cotton acreage | expanding | expanding rapidly | very high

Average crop diversity on cotton farms | limited | declining | very limited

Farmers reporting debt to merchants or landlords | common | very common | widespread

Membership in farmers’ alliances or agrarian protest groups | low | growing | significant in many areas

The table notes that the figures are approximate and are intended to show broad regional patterns after Reconstruction.

- (a) Describe one economic trend in the post-Reconstruction South reflected in the table.
- (b) Explain one cause of the economic trend described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one political or social response to the agricultural conditions reflected in the table.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid trend, such as the growth of tenancy and sharecropping, dependence on cotton, declining crop diversity, widespread debt, or increasing agrarian protest.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant cause, such as lack of land ownership among freedpeople and poor whites, crop-lien credit systems, falling cotton prices, merchant control of supplies, limited access to capital, or the collapse of Reconstruction-era land redistribution hopes.

(c) 1 point: Explains a relevant response, such as the Farmers’ Alliance, Populist Party organizing, calls for railroad regulation, demands for currency reform, cooperative buying and selling, biracial organizing attempts, or political backlash against agrarian protest.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect agricultural data to systems of credit, labor, and landownership. It should avoid treating sharecropping as simply a personal choice and should explain why economic hardship contributed to organized agrarian protest.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ3-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: MIG — Migration and Settlement

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which immigration transformed American society and politics from 1880 to 1924.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Immigration data table created for this practice exam, United States, 1880–1924.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Immigration Patterns to the United States, 1880–1924.”

Period | Major sending regions | Approximate pattern

1880s | Northern and Western Europe, China, Canada | High immigration; increasing restriction on Chinese immigration

1900s | Southern and Eastern Europe, Mexico, Japan, Canada | Very high immigration; rapid urban growth

1910s | Southern and Eastern Europe, Mexico, Caribbean, Canada | Immigration disrupted by World War I but remained politically contested

1924 | National-origins quotas established | Sharp restriction on immigration from Southern and Eastern Europe; Asian immigration already severely limited

Sourcing Cues: The table emphasizes shifting immigrant origins and the growth of restrictionist policy.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from an Italian immigrant woman to her sister, New York City, 1907; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The rooms are crowded, and the work in the garment shop is long, but there is bread each week and school for the children. In the neighborhood we hear Italian, Yiddish, English, and many other tongues. Some Americans say we bring disorder, yet they buy the coats and dresses our hands sew.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the perspective of a working-class immigrant woman in an urban industrial economy.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated petition from Chinese merchants to a federal official, San Francisco, 1892; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Petition-style primary source.

“We have paid taxes, rented shops, traded honestly, and obeyed local laws. Yet new rules require papers from us that are not demanded of other residents. If exclusion is called protection for labor, why are merchants, students, and families treated as if they are criminals for crossing the ocean?”

Sourcing Cues: The petition reflects Chinese immigrant resistance to exclusion laws and unequal treatment under federal policy.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated report from a settlement-house worker, Chicago, 1905; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Reform report excerpt.

“New arrivals need English lessons, clean playgrounds, medical clinics, and help understanding city offices. But reform must begin by listening. Families bring skills, music, foodways, and mutual-aid traditions that can strengthen the neighborhood if public officials stop seeing immigrant districts only as problems.”

Sourcing Cues: The report reflects Progressive Era urban reform and a settlement-house perspective that combined assistance, assimilation, and respect for immigrant communities.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from a local labor union meeting, Pennsylvania, 1911;

based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Labor organization statement.

“Employers divide workers by language and hire recent arrivals at wages that no family can live on. The answer is not to blame the newest worker, but to organize across nationality so that the company cannot use hunger against one group and fear against another.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects labor activists’ concern with industrial capitalism, wages, and ethnic division among workers.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Described political cartoon from a restrictionist magazine, United States, 1919.

Source Type: Described political cartoon.

The cartoon shows Uncle Sam standing at a harbor gate labeled “America.” Outside the gate is a large crowd carrying bags labeled “radicalism,” “poverty,” “foreign politics,” and “cheap labor.” Inside the gate, a factory owner smiles while a native-born worker looks worried. The caption reads: “Who benefits from an open door?”

Sourcing Cues: The cartoon reflects post-World War I nativism, fear of radicalism, and concern over labor competition.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Summary of congressional debate over immigration quotas, Washington, D.C., 1924.

Source Type: Legislative debate summary.

Supporters of quotas argued that immigration should be limited to preserve national unity, reduce labor competition, and favor immigrants from regions considered easier to assimilate. Opponents argued that quotas discriminated by national origin, contradicted American ideals, and ignored immigrants’ contributions to industry, agriculture, and military service.

Sourcing Cues: The debate reflects how immigration became a major issue in national politics, law, labor, race, and ideas of American identity.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which immigration transformed American society and politics from 1880 to 1924. The thesis must make an argument, such as that immigration substantially transformed urban labor, culture, reform, and national politics while also provoking restrictionist and nativist reactions.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as industrialization, urbanization, transatlantic migration, railroad expansion, Chinese Exclusion, Progressive reform, World War I, the Red Scare, or debates over national identity.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about labor, urban life, ethnic diversity, exclusion, reform, nativism, or federal restriction.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Ellis Island, Angel Island, Chinese Exclusion Act, Gentlemen’s Agreement, Immigration Act of 1917, Emergency Quota Act, National Origins Act, Americanization programs, political machines, tenements, Triangle Shirtwaist Fire, Sacco and Vanzetti, or the First Red Scare.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the immigrant woman’s labor perspective, Chinese merchants’ challenge to unequal law, settlement workers’ reform purpose, labor unions’ organizing

goals, or the restrictionist cartoon's nativist assumptions.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as showing that immigration transformed both immigrants and native-born Americans, distinguishing between European and Asian immigrant experiences, explaining how employers and labor unions responded differently, or showing how wartime nationalism intensified older nativist ideas.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that immigration transformed American cities, workplaces, culture, and politics to a large extent. It should also explain that transformation produced conflicting responses: immigrants built communities and supplied industrial labor, reformers promoted services and assimilation, labor activists debated solidarity, and nativists pushed restriction. Useful document groupings include immigrant labor and urban life, exclusion and legal discrimination, Progressive reform, labor conflict, and restrictionist politics. Relevant outside evidence could include Ellis Island, Angel Island, the Chinese Exclusion Act, tenements, political machines, the Triangle Shirtwaist Fire, the First Red Scare, or the National Origins Act.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ3-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: ARC — American and Regional Culture

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the colonial period through the antebellum era, religious ideas and institutions shaped American society in many ways. Religious belief influenced community life, education, reform movements, gender ideals, debates over slavery, Native missions, and ideas about moral authority and social change.

Evaluate the extent to which religious ideas and movements caused social or cultural change in British North America and the United States from 1607 to 1860.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent to which religious ideas and movements caused social or cultural change from 1607 to 1860. The thesis must make an argument about causation.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to religion and society, such as European colonization, Puritan settlement, religious pluralism, the First Great Awakening, the American Revolution, the Second Great Awakening, market change, slavery, or antebellum reform.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as Puritan communities, Maryland toleration debates, Quakers, the First Great Awakening, Jonathan Edwards or George Whitefield, evangelical churches, the Second Great Awakening, temperance, abolitionism, women's reform activity, missionary work, utopian communities, or proslavery religious arguments. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about how religion caused social or cultural change.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining causation, such as showing how religious revivalism encouraged challenges to older authority, inspired reform movements, shaped

gender roles, promoted moral discipline, supported abolition, justified slavery, or influenced community organization.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that religion both challenged and reinforced social hierarchies, comparing the First and Second Great Awakenings, distinguishing regional differences, or showing how religious ideas interacted with economic change, democratic politics, race, gender, and reform.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should make a clear causal argument rather than simply listing religious groups. It might argue that religious movements caused major social and cultural change by encouraging revivalism, reform, moral activism, and challenges to established authority. Strong responses should also recognize limits and contradictions, including religious defenses of slavery, gender constraints within reform, and differences among regions and denominations.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ3

- APUSH-SAQ3-001: Unit 3; Period 3: 1754–1800; perspectives include modern secondary historians of revolutionary constitutional conflict and popular mobilization; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast elite imperial-rights arguments with broader participation by artisans, farmers, women, enslaved people, and committees; historical development is the American Revolution as both constitutional conflict and popular political mobilization; reasoning path is comparison using political ideology and social participation; misconception targeted is reducing the Revolution only to taxation or only to elite founders.
- APUSH-SAQ3-002: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; perspective is Mexican American student activist after Los Angeles school walkouts; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes language, curriculum, educational tracking, college access, and Chicano identity; historical development is Latino/a civil rights activism and educational protest in the 1960s; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to institutional discrimination and youth activism; misconception targeted is limiting civil rights history only to Brown v. Board, Martin Luther King Jr., or Black-white southern segregation.
- APUSH-SAQ3-003: Unit 6; Period 6: 1865–1898; perspectives include southern tenant farmers, sharecroppers, merchants, landlords, agrarian organizers, and poor rural communities; non-text source type is plain-text agricultural data table; visual/data pattern is tenancy/sharecropping growth, cotton dependence, debt, crop specialization, and farmers' alliance growth; historical development is the post-Reconstruction southern agricultural economy and agrarian protest; reasoning path is causation linking land, credit, cotton markets, and Populist responses; misconception targeted is treating sharecropping as voluntary independence rather than a debt-based labor and credit system.
- APUSH-DBQ3-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; DBQ topic is immigration's transformation of American society and politics from 1880 to 1924; document types include immigration pattern data table, immigrant woman's letter, Chinese merchant petition, settlement-house reform report, labor union statement, described restrictionist political cartoon, and congressional quota debate summary; document perspectives include southern/eastern European immigrants, Chinese immigrants, settlement-house reformers, industrial workers, labor organizers, nativists, employers, lawmakers, and restrictionists; main argument paths include urban labor transformation, ethnic community formation, legal exclusion, reform and assimilation, labor solidarity/conflict, nativism, Red Scare

fears, and quota politics; outside evidence possibilities include Ellis Island, Angel Island, Chinese Exclusion Act, Gentlemen's Agreement, Immigration Act of 1917, Emergency Quota Act, National Origins Act, Americanization programs, political machines, tenements, Triangle Shirtwaist Fire, Sacco and Vanzetti, and the First Red Scare; sourcing opportunities include immigrant labor perspective, Chinese legal discrimination critique, settlement-house reform purpose, union organizing audience, restrictionist cartoon assumptions, and congressional national-identity debates; visual/data/map types include immigration pattern data table and described restrictionist political cartoon.

· APUSH-LEQ3-001: Units 2–4; Periods 2–4 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is religious ideas and movements as causes of social or cultural change from 1607 to 1860; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include Puritan communities, religious pluralism, Quakers, First Great Awakening, evangelical revivalism, Second Great Awakening, temperance, abolitionism, women's reform activity, missionary work, utopian communities, and religious defenses of slavery; complexity path is showing that religion could both challenge and reinforce social hierarchies while interacting with region, gender, race, democracy, and economic change; misconception targeted is treating religion as separate from politics, reform, slavery, gender, and social organization.